

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2021

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 73)

3.1. (max 39)

- 1-4: 2 points for each completely correct English translation. (max 12)
 - 1 point with one wrong or missing word.
 - Allow two answers for 3 and 4, so 6 translations are possible.
 - Accept
 - *give a lot* or similar for *donate*
 - *look at* for *see*
 - *hear for* *listen to*
 - 1 point for #1: *You (sg) have seen/looked/watched*, without an object pronoun
- 5-10: (max 27)
 - 1 point for each morpheme (underlined and separated by +)
 - 1 point for each other completely correct Ainu word except *wa*.

3.2. Assign marks as shown in the commentary (max 34)

	Ainu	English
1	e nukarepa wa isam	You (sg) have shown/showed them.
2	ci yaynukarpa wa oka	We were seeing/looking at ourselves.
3	e koreruy wa an	He was donating you (sg). OR: They were donating you (sg). OR: You (sg) were donating (him).
4	nuruypa wa isam	He has listened (to him/them) a lot. OR: They have listened (to him/them) a lot.
5	eci <u>nu+pa</u> wa oka [4]	He was listening to you (pl).
6	e <u>yay+nu+ruy</u> wa an [5]	You (sg) were thinking a lot.
7	ci <u>kore+tek+re</u> wa an [5]	We were borrowing him.
8	<u>ipe+pa</u> as wa isam [4]	We have eaten.
9	<u>inkar+ruy+pa</u> wa oka [4]	They were staring.
10	an <u>nukar+tek+pa</u> wa isam [5]	I have glanced at them.

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Commentary

- **Syntax: (max 4)**
 - Every sentence ends with an 'aspect' marker (see below) following the word *wa*. **[1]**
 - Background: Subjects and objects are 'arguments' of the verb. Grammarians classify verbs by their transitivity as 'intransitive' (with one argument, e.g. *snore*) or 'transitive' verbs (with two arguments, e.g. *kick*). The two arguments of a transitive verb can be distinguished as 'agent' (A) and 'patient' (P), as in *She kicked it*, where she is the agent and it is the patient.
 - Transitivity affects word order in Ainu, as follows (Key: P = pronoun, V = verb, A = aspect particle)
 - Default: P V *wa* A **[2]**
 - Intransitive first person (I or we): V P *wa* A **[1]**
 - Background: Languages are classified according to how they treat the subject of an intransitive verb (S), and the agent (A) and patient (P) of a transitive verb. In a nominative-accusative language like English, S and A have similar treatment (e.g. *she*, not *her*) in contrast with P, while an ergative-absolutive language aligns S with P as 'absolutive', in contrast with A, called 'ergative' (Greek for 'working', as in *en-ergy*). In these terms, Ainu is partly nominative-accusative and partly ergative-absolutive, so we need both kinds of terminology: subject/object, and ergative/absolutive.
- **Pronouns: (max 9)**
 - Pronouns have three forms: **[2]**
 - for an intransitive subject
 - for a transitive subject
 - for a transitive object.
 - When two pronouns belong to the same verb, they fuse into a single word; for example, if the subject is 'you(pl)' and the object is 'me', *eci-* combines with *-en* to give *ecien*. **[2]**
 - The three forms are given in the following table.

Person	intransitive subject	transitive subject	object	points
1 sg	an	an-	-en	[1]
2 sg	e	e-	-e	[1]
3 sg	[zero]	[zero]	[zero]	[1]
1 pl	as	ci-	-un	[1]
2 pl	eci	eci-	-eci	[1]
3 pl	[zero]	[zero]	[zero]	

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- **Verbs: (max 16)**

- Each verb has two different roots depending on its transitivity: [2]
- The verbs are shown in the following table. [2; 1 for just one example]

Translation	Intransitive root	Transitive root
to eat	ipe	e
to see	inkar	nukar
to listen	inu	nu
to have/give	kor	kore**

** For this problem, **kore** *give* can be taken as a separate root from **kor** *have*, though it is actually the causative of **kor** (*give* = *cause someone to have*).

- There are also several stem-modifying affixes: (max 10)
 - **yay-** [1]: reflexive marker [1]
 - (note that in Ainu, *listening to oneself* = *thinking*) [1]
 - **-(r)e** [1]: causative marker (*eat* → *make someone eat* = *feed*, *see* → *make someone see* = *show*, *listen* = *make someone listen* → *tell*). [1]
 - If the verb root ends in **-r**, the suffix becomes **-e**. [1]
 - **-ruy** [1]: verb intensifier (can be translated by *a lot*, but it also bears a semantic role modifying the verb (*eat* → *devour*, *see* → *stare* etc.) [1]
 - **-tek** [1]: verb diminisher (the opposite of **-ruy** – *eat* → *taste*, *see* → *glance* etc.) [1]
- **-pa** is added if the absolutive is plural. [2]
- **Aspect: (max 5)**
 - Past perfect (*has/have Ved*) [1]: – **wa isam** [1]
 - Past continuous (*was/were Ving*): [1]
 - **wa an** if the absolutive is singular [1]
 - **wa oka** if it is plural. [1]